

https://www.smdailyjournal.com/news/local/redwood-city-residents-urge-review-of-flock-safety-contract/article_90e0686d-4dd9-42f8-b6a6-266c3c70936e.html

FEATURED

Redwood City residents urge review of Flock Safety contract

By Ana Mata, Daily Journal staff
Jul 29, 2026



f X           in

   ıkıř Sinyali Kabul Edildi

With privacy and safety concerns over unauthorized access to automated license plate reader data, Redwood City residents asked the City Council to cancel its contract with Flock Safety and reevaluate the city's need for the technology altogether.

Kabul et

Gerekli Olmayanları Reddet

Residents showed up to the City Council meeting Monday evening to ask councilmember to not renew their contract for the automated license plate readers in September. The concern follows [national scrutiny over Flock Safety](#), a surveillance technology company, over mass data collection and sharing with law enforcement beyond city limits, including federal agencies.

“Automated License Plate Readers have become one of the most pervasive surveillance tools used by federal agencies to surveil and ultimately detain the most vulnerable members of our communities,” Diane Savage, an organizer with Indivisible Mid-Peninsula.

The Redwood City Council approved its contract with Flock for 25 cameras in 2023, and police said the technology would help them identify vehicles involved in crimes.

The city also looked to include safeguards to protect resident privacy as much as possible, Mayor Elmer Martínez Saballos said.

“I know we’re finding ourselves in a really difficult landscape with these federal agencies that we’re seeing operate in our communities right now and that’s driving so much of the concerns from the neighbors I’m hearing from,” Martínez Saballos said. “I also believe the City Council, when we reviewed this tech, we had protections and safeguards put into place.”

Whether those guardrails have been effective will be the focus of any future council decision, he said.

The city’s policy on the technology states that immigration enforcement, traffic enforcement, harassment, intimidation and use based on a protected class such as [race, sex and religion](#) are prohibited. It also states that the technology cannot identify individuals through facial recognition.

Bu web sitesi, temel site işlevlerinin yanı sıra mantıksal analiz, kişiselleştirme ve hedeflenmiş reklamcılık için çerezler gibi teknolojiler kullanır. [Gizlilik Politikası](#)

However, outside law enforcement agencies were found to have improperly accessed data generated by the automated license plate reader system in numerous cities, without permission from the respective law enforcement agencies.

Flock Safety acknowledged the issue in March, stating some California agencies “had their camera networks inadvertently accessible to out-of-state law enforcement agencies for a period of time,” according to a company statement. The company said it was “impossible to determine a specific cause” for the data breach.

For the concerned residents, the threat of potential data breaches is reason enough to cancel the contract.

“Many of us have been sold the lie that we have to give up some of our privacy in the name of safety but the choice between privacy and safety is a false choice,” Emily Morris said during public comment. “The reality is the ALPRs both compromise our privacy and make us all less safe.”

There has been no evidence of unauthorized access into Redwood City’s technology data, according to Redwood City police. Still, the department is reviewing the license plate reader program, and a full update will be presented at the city’s Police Advisory Committee meeting Aug. 12.

Following the swarm of public comment at the City Council’s meeting Monday, Martínez Saballos said he is working with city staff to look into the matter and will be paying close attention to the PAC’s meeting Aug. 12.

“If we do see a robust [turnout] of the community at this next PAC meeting, that would give us even more of a green light to organize a town hall on the subject, to have a study session on this as a council,” Martínez Saballos said. “If there are enough questions, that means there’s an appetite in the community to do education outreach and gather input.”

Çıkış Sinyali Kabul Edildi

The city’s contract with Flock Safety is slated to renew in September, but would go toward the City Council one way or another for final approval, Martínez Saballos said.

Any redirection following the Aug. 12 meeting will need to be made swiftly, Martínez Saballos said.

“It’s a quick timeline but we’re ready to act quickly and receive that input depending on what we see at the PAC meeting,” Martínez Saballos said.

ana@smdailyjournal.com

(65) 344-5200 ext. 106



MORE INFORMATION



License plate reader helps catch theft suspects in Redwood City

California sues, says El Cajon police are illegally sharing license plate info with other agencies

Flock camera data has insufficient systemic oversight in San Mateo County, grand jury finds

Redwood City to let Flock Safety contract expire over automatic license plate readers concerns

Bu web sitesi, temel site işlevlerinin yanı sıra mantıksal analiz, kişiselleştirme ve hedeflenmiş reklamcılık için çerezler gibi teknolojiler kullanır. **Gizlilik Politikası**

Ana Mata, Daily Journal staff

Daily Journal staff

● Çıkış Sinyali Kabul Edildi

Bu web sitesi, temel site işlevlerinin yanı sıra mantıksal analiz, kişiselleştirme ve hedeflenmiş reklamcılık için çerezler gibi teknolojiler kullanır. **Gizlilik Politikası**